doors and windows. Soon, national TV channels also started airing their own sting operations.

Bankers, already reeling under the pressure of the note ban, now had to face to wrath of the public. Citizens, exhausted and enraged by the never-ending queues, assumed that all banks were guilty of such collusion and made bankers their target. There were stone-throwing incidents at many branches, and bankers everywhere in the country were subject to abuse and derision.

By the end of December, officials of several major banks were fired or arrested for alleged illegal conversion or exchange of demonetized currency notes.

Here is an illustrative, though not exhaustive, list culled from various press reports:[55]

- On 3 December 2016, HDFC Bank announced that it had sacked four employees, including a branch manager, for allegedly indulging in unauthorized exchange of demonetized currency notes.
- On 4 December, the Enforcement Directorate arrested two managers of the Kashmere Gate, Delhi branch of Axis Bank for converting black money into white, by reportedly misusing banking transfer systems like Real Time Gross Settlement (RTGS) and National Electronic Fund Transfers (NEFT). The duo was arrested after two people were caught with ₹3.5 crore cash in new currency.
- On 9 December, tax officials seized over ₹100 crore from 44 suspect accounts from an Axis Bank branch in the Chandni Chowk area in Delhi.
- On 15 December, Income Tax officials raided an Axis Bank branch in Sector 51 in Noida and froze 20 suspect accounts with deposits totalling around ₹60 crore.
- On 17 December, the CBI arrested two employees of the cash department of RBI in Bengaluru in connection with the alleged